

Experiment Log — Sprint 4: Willingness-to-Pay

Venture: Parlance
Date range: June 26 – July 10, 2026
Experiment type: Pricing / monetization validation
Submitted by: Team Parlance

Hypothesis

≥40% of users who completed 2+ practice sessions will express willingness to pay
≥\$5/month for unlimited Parlance access.

Experiment Design

Element	Detail
Method	In-app pricing page + intent form (Parlance /pricing)
Participants	15 warm leads (10 from Sprint 3 + 5 new from career fair demo)
Tiers shown	Free (\$0), Student (\$7.99/mo), Pro (\$14.99/mo)
Data captured	Interest yes/no, preferred tier, max monthly price (slider \$3–\$25)
Success metric	≥40% "yes" with max price ≥ \$5
Comparison	Free alternatives: ChatGPT free, YouTube, journaling

Results

Pricing intent (n=15)

Response	Count	%
Would pay	9	60% 
Free only	6	40%

Preferred tier (paying users only, n=9)

Tier	Count
Student (\$7.99)	7

Student (\$7.99)	1
Pro (\$14.99)	2

Max price willing to pay (n=9)

Stat	Value
Mean	\$9.44/mo
Median	\$8/mo
Min	\$5
Max	\$15

Objections from "free only" users (n=6)

- "ChatGPT is free" (4) — counter: ChatGPT isn't interview-specific or tracked
- "Only need it before one interview" (3) — suggests pay-per-cycle or annual option
- "Student budget" (2) — validates \$7.99 student tier

Van Westendorp summary (simplified)

From max-price slider responses:

- **Point of marginal cheapness:** ~\$4 (below this, quality doubted)
- **Indifference price:** ~\$8
- **Point of marginal expensiveness:** ~\$12

Recommended launch price: \$7.99/mo Student tier (matches median WTP)

AI Leverage

- AI summarized open-text pricing objections into 3 categories in minutes
- Generated 5 pricing page copy variants; A/B tested with 8 users (variant B: "Less than one coffee a week" had 25% higher intent)

Business model learning

Freemium viable: Free tier (2 sessions/week) as acquisition; Student tier as conversion target. One-time "Interview Prep Pack" (\$4.99) requested by 3 users — consider for Sprint 5.

Risk assumption tested

Assumption	Result
Willingness to pay exists	✅ 60% at ≥\$5/mo (exceeds 40% threshold)

Rubric self-assessment

Pillar	Score	Notes
Learning velocity	4	Pricing test in 2 weeks post-retention
Problem significance	4	Pay intent confirms value beyond free tools
AI integration	3	AI for copy A/B and objection analysis
Venture progress	5	Full loop: discovery → MVP → retention → pricing
Responsible impact	4	No dark patterns; clear free tier
Coachability	4	Adjusted tier naming based on feedback

Overall venture status (end of Sprint 4)

Stage 1 status	End of July status
Pre-product, pre-revenue	Working MVP with 10+ active testers
10–15 interviews planned	22 interviews completed
Hypotheses untested	4/5 risk assumptions tested; transfer needs more data

Recommended next steps

1. Audio input/output mode (top feature request)
2. Larger retention cohort (n=30) with real-world transfer survey at 30 days
3. Pilot with UNCW Career Center as distribution partner or with external fundings
4. Strine integration for paid beta